



RheinBrücke's ERP Solutions for Distribution Industry Built on Epicor ERP

Driving Performance in the Supply Chain

Introduction

The distribution sector is facing a time of disruption. With growing global competition and high customer expectations, distributors are under a lot of pressure to maintain optimal levels of efficiency and precision. Effective distribution means having the right tools to efficiently plan, assemble, ship, and deliver the goods your customers want when they want them. It's one thing to understand the distribution needs of your organization, but quite another to execute at peak performance. For that, you need the right software solution. ERP tools present a bold new way for distribution companies to operate.

With RheinBrücke's expertise of implementing Epicor solutions for leading Distributors and the strong technology offered by the world-class Epicor ERP platform, you get the most powerful system available for managing the complex demands of the distribution industry. It offers you the full range of functionality you require, including in-depth supply chain solutions, customer relationship management, business intelligence, and more to help you tackle today's and tomorrow's challenges. So, whether you simply pick, pack, and ship or provide extensive multi-order channel processing with fulfilment services on your clients' behalf, our solution provides the competitive edge you've been looking for.

We draw upon our unparalleled experience in the industry, our understanding of country-specific requirements, and our long-standing Epicor partnership to deliver value to our customers.

Our ERP solution addresses a number of challenges of modern distributors

Key Challenges in the Distribution Industry



Collaborating with customers and suppliers



Tracking advertisement and promotion expenses



Managing traceability of merchandise



Controlling diverse inventories across multiple locations



Handling multiple divisions dealing with different types of product ranges



Order Processing



Reducing inventory replenishment errors



Managing charge-backs, returned merchandise and multiple currencies



Analysing sales and reaching optimal pricing



Managing Bank Guarantee and LC Life Cycle with request and approval



Managing goods in transit



Forward Contract Management



Management of Advertisements & Promotions and Supplier Contributions



Receivable collection



Procurement Planning



Asset Management



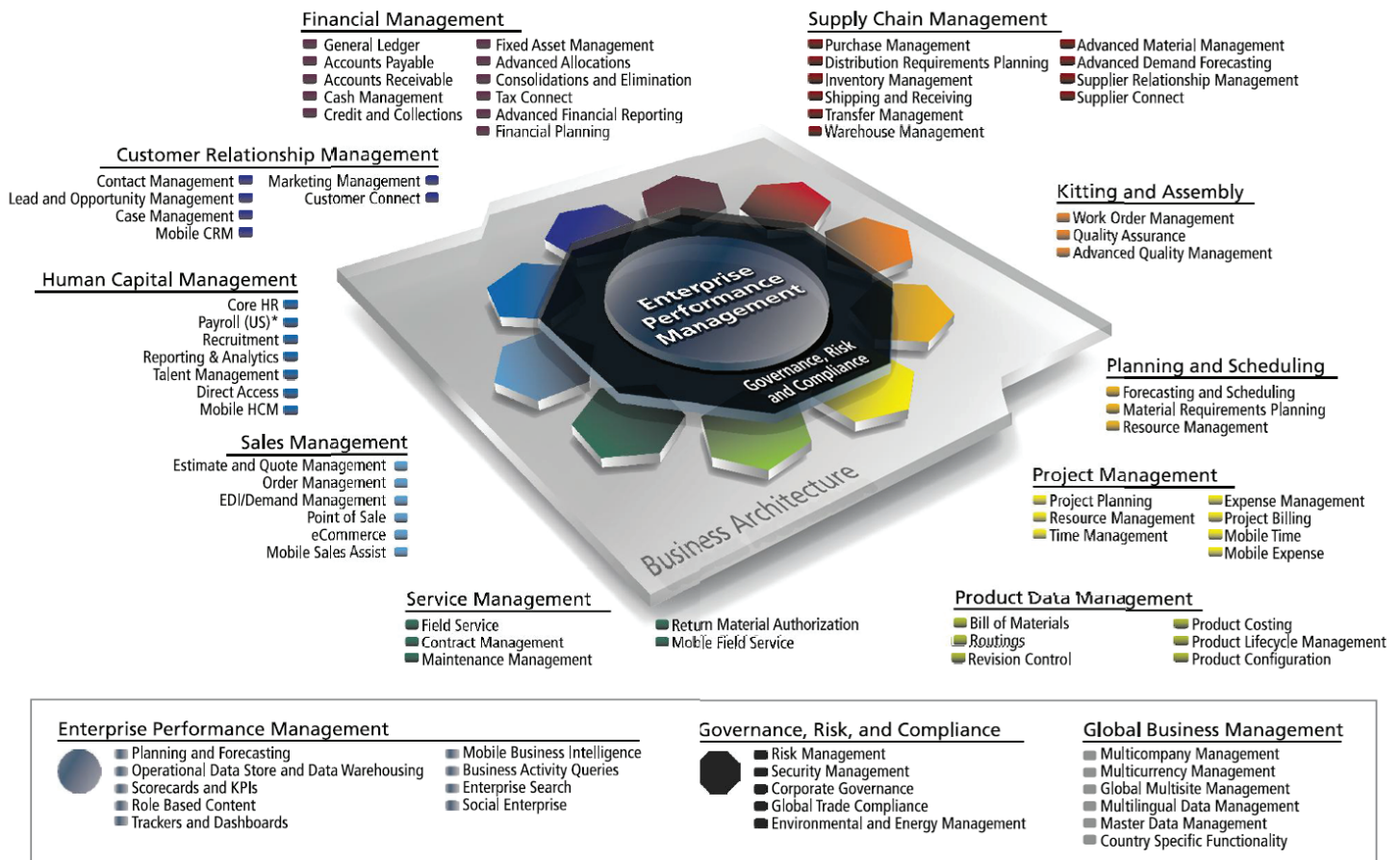
Tracking Free of Cost (FOC) Products



Minimizing costs

A Unique Solution Delivering Unparalleled Functionalities for Distributors

Our Solution for Distributors built on Epicor ERP offers full range of features to meet the needs of the distribution industry – Order management, Supply Chain Management, Warehousing, Supplier Relationship Management, Financial Management, Customer Relationship Management and more. It supports your company's growth with rapid implementation and easy expansion, no matter the size or diversity of your supply chain.



Our solution combines powerful features of Epicor ERP along with numerous enhancements configured by RheinBrücke's experts based on proven best practices aggregated from our multiple distribution industry implementations. Thus, the solution can be adapted quickly to meet the very specific needs of your business not addressed by many ERP vendors in the market now and can ensure more value from your ERP implementation.

The platform is uniquely positioned to manage the requirements of multiple industries within a single solution including Consumer Goods, Pharmaceuticals, Chemicals and Allied Products, Industrial Machinery, Wholesales/Industrial, Automotive, Aerospace and Defence, Medical Device, Electronics and High Tech, HVAC, Furniture and Fixtures, Rubber and Plastics, and more.

Features of Our Solution

The major features of our solution include:

Inventory Management and Tracking

- ✓ Extensive inventory management including cradle-to-grave serial and lot control, and item cross-reference
- ✓ Company, site, warehouse, and bin level visibility and management of inventory
- ✓ Streamlined fulfilment process for reservation or allocation of inventories with queue and task management of all transactions
- ✓ Flexible cycle counting and physical inventory
- ✓ Advanced procurement planning incorporating the Purchase Forecast, Sales Forecast and the Stock Cover report values in MRP processing
- ✓ Min shelf-life tracking and liquidation process for managing the minimum shelf life of the items in stock and automatically moving the items into the liquidation warehouse with notifications



- ✓ Customer and supplier managed inventories
- ✓ Comprehensive supply chain management, including demand-driven purchase and kitting suggestions
- ✓ Tracking for Free of Cost product along with the normal products without impacting average cost

Warehousing and Asset Management

- ✓ Full support of radio frequency (RF) wireless data collection and barcode scanning for warehouse transactions, directed and/or user initiated
- ✓ Full support of kitted items including engineered assembly requirements
- ✓ Multiple units of measurement tracking throughout
- ✓ Asset management with requests and approval - Auto generation of Asset Master and transfer of asset from inventory with approval workflow, Fixed Asset Schedule department and division wise, Leased Asset Management, etc.
- ✓ Event-driven, highly configurable barcode print routines are embedded throughout the warehouse operations enabling standard and 2D label generation and RFID tag output
- ✓ Integration to material handling and equipment (conveyors, scales, etc.)



Order Management and Logistics

- ✓ Extensive features for Order Processing - Load/Route Planning, FOC, RMA, Margin Analysis, Delivery Management, etc
- ✓ Numerous costing methods supported, including average, last, FIFO, lot, and standard costing
- ✓ Comprehensive features for Purchase Order Processing - handling Commission, handling Charges in PO, AP Invoice and Supplier Payments, Margin Analysis, etc.
- ✓ PO level container optimization based on the nature of the product, quantity ordered and the space available in the container from a particular port with temperature-controlled container and sorting process
- ✓ Comprehensive shipment tracking features - tracking shipment from supplier and giving time to time alerts / intimation to respective department users, tracking of Invoice against the shipments with various document tracking details, verification of registration and approvals from respective authority for "Flagged" items, insurance claim request and insurance tracking for the damaged items during the transport, etc.



- ✓ Extensive landed cost capabilities and container tracking
- ✓ Optimized shipping encompasses carrier integration with FedEx®, UPS®, DHL, USPS®, LTL X Supports drop ship and cross-docking functionality

Billing and Discounting

- ✓ Service Management features including tracking of supplier warranty for the serviced items, extended service warranty from retailer customers, warning message for repeated service of same equipment, etc.
- ✓ Accurate and agile finance and accounting – Divisional Accounting, General Ledger, Accounts Payable, Accounts Receivable, Accrual mechanism for recovery of expenses and debit note management, Currency Trend Analysis Report and Exchange Rate history, BG and LC Lifecycle Management and more
- ✓ Advertisement and Promotion management features including contractual discount and additional discount where the discount can be given at the sales order level from attached price list or sales order level, calculating the FOC goods calculation and automatically apply at the Purchase Order level, separate deal management against supplier for managing deal-based rebate bonus goods and contribution discount, etc.
- ✓ Options for tracking advertisement and promotion expenses paid to / incurred by customers against that claim from supplier.



- ✓ Promotional scheme quantity or value level and deal-based sales order, assign to customer or customer ship to level for a certain period which is given in the same sales order or referred sales order respectively
- ✓ Manage shelf rental and rebate contracts for accounting accrual periodically against customers and giving credit note to customers based on the request.
- ✓ Separate deal management against supplier for managing deal-based rebate bonus goods and contribution discount

And many more...

- ✓ Centralized customer relationship management
- ✓ Efficient multichannel sales order processing
- ✓ Customer and supplier portals, dashboards and enterprise search to support enterprise performance management initiatives
- ✓ Support for global trade standards, country of origin, and RoHS compliance
- ✓ Global, multicompany, multisite, multi-warehouse management
- ✓ eCommerce integration

Our Solution Advantages – Customer Success Story

RheinBrücke's ERP Solutions for Distributors helps them drive business process improvement in their organization not just by capitalizing on the latest technologies, but by using those technologies to streamline and standardize their core processes.

As a recent example, one of the largest consumer services groups in Kuwait, involved in sales and distribution of an array of products including Pharmaceuticals, Consumer Health Care, Medical Equipment, Perfumes and Cosmetics, FMCG (Consumer and Food), & Cafes and Restaurants, partnered with us to improve their processes.

The challenges they faced were no different from others in the industry – inventory management, procurement planning based on demands, collaborating with supplier and customers, tracking goods and so on. Business process mapping of the key processes unveiled inefficiencies and bottlenecks – caused by stand-alone systems and manual entries in spreadsheets. Once the team identified these gaps and established a desired future state, they integrated and automated business processes across the business with the help of RheinBrücke.

Our Solution was implementation of Epicor ERP with enhancements designed to address some of their particular challenges in areas like Advertisement & Promotions, Tender Management, Procurement Planning, Purchase Order processing, Shipment Tracker, Service Management, Order Processing, Warehouse Management, Inventory management, etc. It also included several features for managing user Security, Supplier Contribution, Cash/Bank Enhancement, Forward Contract Management, Supplier Payment Process, Recovery of expenses, Receivable Collection and PDC Auto Allocation, Currency Trend Analysis, Asset Management with Requests and approval and more.

The solution enabled them to streamline their processes and gain accurate, real-time insights based on a single version of the truth. It helped them save time, eliminate errors, and ultimately improve customer satisfaction. Some of the major business benefits our customer experienced leveraging our solution are:

Business Benefits

-  Streamlined supply chain processes
-  Provided comprehensive visibility
-  Real-time information across all departments
-  Better management and tighter stock control
-  Simplified claim and scheme processing
-  Enhanced customer satisfaction
-  Optimised inventory management
-  Reduced operating costs
-  Improved business performance
-  Improved communications
-  Better demand planning
-  Improved reporting accuracy
-  Simplified sales processes
-  Better quality control
-  Enhanced productivity

The RheinBrücke Advantages

Deployment on the RheinBrücke Cloud

The solution is deployed on the highly secure RheinBrücke Cloud hosted in the Moro Hub Datacenter. Maintenance, Security and Business continuity are all part and parcel of the solution. The modern cloud deployment gives you added advantages of lower cost, flexibility and frees up your time and resources spent on maintenance.

RAPID Implementation using SCALE Methodology



RheinBrücke's standardized SCALE methodology driven by industry best practices ensures a successful ERP implementation in a short time span by minimizing risk and maximizing predictability with clearly defined deliverables and processes. It is a scalable approach for implementation that is designed to address your needs based on the foundation elements – Solutioning, Consulting Expertise, Agile Practices, Learning and Enablement.

RheinBrücke Academy



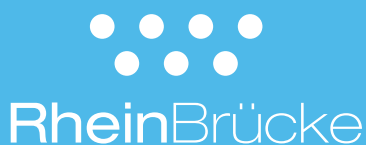
We offer a comprehensive Learning Management platform for our customers to ensure effective training of end users as well as key users and administrators. The platform provides interactive simulation-based learning content which ensures 100% module coverage for all your users.

Support

RheinBrücke's Omnichannel Support driven by a robust ticketing system ensures that your business users have the support and help readily available from our large pool of Epicor Certified professional engineers who have worked on multiple complex global ERP implementations.

About RheinBrücke

RheinBrücke is a European company with global mindset and a strong footprint in Europe, Middle East, and India. We have immense experience and expertise in providing Enterprise Business Solutions, Surround IT Solutions, Consulting Services and Product Development Services to clients globally across 34 countries. RheinBrücke's flagship product, **MeRLIN** is an integrated solution for Direct & Indirect Sourcing with Supplier Relationship Management, Sourcing Automation and Planning augmented by Advanced Analytics. RheinBrücke is an Epicor Premium Partner and two times winner of International Partner of the Year, as well as Microsoft Gold Partner. Our team of experts with Six Sigma and PMP as well as our proprietary SCALE Methodology certification can deliver robust enterprise solutions and offerings to address the needs of businesses on multiple verticals including Automotive Systems, Oil & Gas / Energy, Discrete & Process Manufacturing, Engineering, Procurement & Construction, Retail & Distribution, Public Sector, etc. Our strong distribution channel across the globe supported by our robust RheinBrücke Academy based training and omnichannel support ensures seamless delivery of solutions and services. With a deep understanding of what it takes for enterprises to succeed, RheinBrücke helps clients adapt to a changing marketplace by ensuring their IT ecosystems are relevant, efficient, and perfectly tuned.



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